

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Drugmakers Novo Nordisk** and Pfizer raised their offers in the multibillion-dollar takeover battle for obesity-drug developer Metsera, the latest twist in their unusual fight over the startup. **A1**
- ◆ **Pfizer reported** lower third-quarter profit and sales as demand for its Covid-19 vaccine and antiviral drug continued to decline. **B2**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** retreated, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials sliding 1.2%, 2% and 0.5%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Norway's sovereign-wealth fund** rejected Tesla Chief Executive Elon Musk's new \$1 trillion pay package, becoming the first major investor to disclose its decision. **B1**
- ◆ **Uber said that more** customers are turning to its platform for rides and deliveries, and the company expects gross bookings to continue to grow. **B1**
- ◆ **First Brands' new** management team sued founder Patrick James, alleging he enriched himself at the company's expense. **B1**
- ◆ **Archer Daniels Midlands** cut its outlook for the third time this year, saying confusion around tariffs and lower soybean prices continue to hurt its business. **B7**
- ◆ **Jeep maker Chrysler** recalled about 320,000 hybrid vehicles in the U.S. over concerns that high-voltage batteries may fail and lead to a fire. **B2**
- ◆ **Marriott narrowed its** full-year earnings outlook after reporting higher quarterly profit and revenue, as strength in the luxury segment more than offset reduced government travel. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Democratic socialist** Zohran Mamdani won the New York City mayoral race, while Democrats captured the governor's mansions in New Jersey and Virginia, in the first major electoral test of Trump's second term. **A4**
- ◆ **Senators said they** were increasingly optimistic that they could reach a bipartisan deal to end the federal government shutdown. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump said he would** block federal food-aid funding until Democrats vote to reopen the government. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is negotiating a deal with Eli Lilly and Novo Nordisk that would allow the lowest doses of some of their obesity drugs to be sold to consumers at \$149 for a month's supply via TrumpRx. **A6**
- ◆ **Trump renominated** Jared Isaacman to run NASA a few months after dropping his initial support for him to head the space agency. **A3**
- ◆ **The trial began of a man** charged with misdemeanor assault for throwing a sandwich at a Customs and Border Protection agent. **A3**
- ◆ **A UPS plane** crashed in Louisville, Ky., hitting two businesses. At least four people died and 11 were injured. **A2**
- ◆ **Typhoon Kalmaegi left** at least 26 dead in the Philippines, mostly in flooding. **A8**
- ◆ **Haiti's government said** the death toll from Hurricane Melissa rose to 43, with 13 people still missing. **A18**
- ◆ **Died: Dick Cheney**, 84, former vice president. **A1** ... **Victor Conte**, 75, steroids-scandal figure. **A2**

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Mamdani Leads Democratic Wins



First Muslim to be NYC mayor; party scores victories in New Jersey, Virginia

By ANVEE BHUTANI
AND ALYSSA LUKPAT

Democratic nominee Zohran Mamdani won the New York City mayoral race Tuesday on a big night for his party, cementing the democratic socialist's meteoric rise in the epicenter of global capitalism and making him the first Muslim to lead the U.S.'s most populous city.

Mamdani defeated former Gov. Andrew Cuomo, a Democrat running as an independent, and Republican Curtis Sliwa. With an estimated 90% of the vote counted, Mamdani had 50% to Cuomo's 42% and Sliwa's 7%.

Democrats rolled to victory in two other races Tuesday, capturing the governor's mansions in New Jersey and Virginia, in the first major electoral test of President Trump's second term.

In Virginia, Abigail Spanberger was elected the state's first female governor. And in

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Tuesday was a big night for Democrats as, from left, Abigail Spanberger was elected Virginia's first female governor, Zohran Mamdani rallied young voters to become New York City's next mayor, and Mikie Sherrill won the New Jersey governor's race.

Data-Center Boom Reshapes Small Towns

By DAVID UBERTI

UMATILLA, Ore.—Yesenia Leon-Tejeda, like many people on the frontier of America's tech boom, is basking in new-found prosperity.

Her hometown in northeast Oregon was not long ago known for a former chemical-weapons depot nearby, a state prison on the city's outskirts and the strip clubs once dotting its main drag. But a growing fleet of Amazon data centers has turned the region around Umatilla into an unlikely nerve center for one of

the most expensive infrastructure build-outs in U.S. history.

The tech giant has pumped jobs, people and money into the community of roughly 8,000, doubling many home prices and enticing builders to etch new neighborhoods into surrounding hillsides. That means dollar signs for realtors like Leon-Tejeda.

The daughter of Mexican-born farmhands, Leon-Tejeda worked 12-hour shifts at a distribution center before qualifying for a real-estate license. Now, she is on pace to close 35 deals this year. The 35-

year-old aims to raise her kids in a soon-to-be-built house overlooking the Columbia River and has her eye on Airbnb investments to cash in on the region's growth.

"It's a family victory and God's blessing," she said of her new home. "People are wanting to come to Umatilla now."

America's tech build-out has minted millionaires in Silicon Valley, helped a record-breaking stock market defy gravity and buoyed an otherwise uncertain U.S. economy. Investment in software and

information-processing equipment drove most of America's GDP growth in the first half of 2025, according to federal data. The top five tech giants—known as hyperscalers in the data-center world—total more than a third of all S&P 500 capital expenditures.

Companies are throwing money at digital innovation to become more profitable with fewer workers down the road. But the sheer scale of investment has obscured how it is already reshaping America, in the form of windowless buildings the size of multiple foot-

ball fields where businesses store and process information.

That development is injecting vast sums of cash into sometimes unexpected corners of the country—many of them bypassed by previous booms.

The avalanche of money, which most recent federal data put at \$41 billion in annual investment, isn't spread evenly. Goldman Sachs estimated roughly 72% of all server-farm capacity sat in just 1% of counties as of July.

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Bidding War for Obesity Startup Metsera Escalates

By PETER LOFTUS
AND CONNOR HART

Drugmakers Novo Nordisk and Pfizer raised their offers in the multibillion-dollar takeover battle for obesity-drug developer Metsera, the latest twist in their unusual fight over the startup.

Metsera said Tuesday that Novo Nordisk's proposal values the biotech company at up to \$86.20 a share, or approximately \$10 billion, up from its previous bid of \$9 billion.

This valuation represents

an approximately 159% premium to Metsera's closing price on Sept. 19, the last trading day before the Pfizer deal was disclosed.

Pfizer's new offer values Metsera at up to \$70 a share, or about \$8.1 billion. Pfizer had previously struck a deal to purchase the startup for as much as \$7.3 billion.

It is rare for companies to reopen bidding after a deal

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◆ **Weight-loss drugmakers** aim to sell on TrumpRx.. **A6**

Cheney, Former Vice President And Security Hawk, Dies at 84

By JOHN D. MCKINNON

Dick Cheney, who served four Republican presidents and whose role as an architect of the post-9/11 war on terror made him one of the most powerful—and controversial—U.S. vice presidents in history, died on Monday. He was 84.

He died due to complications of pneumonia and cardiac and vascular disease, his family said.

A national-security hawk with a penchant for working the levers of power, Cheney will be remembered for his relentless advocacy for the 2003 U.S. invasion of Iraq, a move



Dick Cheney in 2012.

that many Americans came to view as a strategic and humanitarian disaster. The war had far-reaching policy and

political consequences, helping turn the public against intervention and upheaving Republican politics.

Cheney continued to defend the Iraq invasion long after he left office in 2009. He suggested the George W. Bush administration's success in preventing more attacks after 9/11 had fed Americans' skepticism of foreign entanglements. He also continued to press his dark view of international threats and his interventionist leanings.

"As we got further from 9/11, there was a tendency for a lot of people to say, 'Let

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Africans Put Soccer Ditty To Grim Use

* * *

English anthem enlisted to bring dead leader home

By NICHOLAS BARIYO

NDOLA, Zambia—In the latest bizarre twist in a bizarre story, fans of the late Zambian President Edgar Lungu have appropriated an English soccer ditty to advocate for the return of his body to the southern African country.

Zambia's current president, Hakainde Hichilema, wants Lungu—who died in June while seeking medical treatment in South Africa—buried in Zambia. Lungu's family says he despised Hichilema so much that he barred his political rival from his funeral. They want to keep even more dis-

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Russian 'Black Widows' Cash In on War Deaths

By MATTHEW LUXMOORE
AND MILAN CZERNY

When Russian soldier Sergey Khandozhko got married the day after enlisting in October 2023, his family and friends were confused. The 40-year-old had never mentioned the bride. Nor had he spoken of marriage.

More puzzling was the 20-minute wedding ceremony without photos or exchange of rings, and only one guest. Afterward, Khandozhko's new wife even continued living with her ex-husband and their children, according to testimony and a court ruling reviewed by The Wall Street Journal.

But alarm bells began to ring after Khandozhko died of injuries inflicted on the battlefield in Ukraine and his bride received the lump sum paid to every fallen soldier's next of kin, the soldier's sister-in-law said in an interview. The pay-

out, totaling \$200,000, is almost 20 times the average annual salary in Russia.

A judge in a Russian civil court ruled this year that Khandozhko's bride, Elena Sokolova, had tricked him into marrying her so she could collect his inheritance. The marriage was annulled and Sokolova had to pay a 3,000-ruble fine, equivalent to \$37. Sokolova, who has appealed the court's ruling, didn't respond to requests for comment.

Targeting Russian soldiers for financial gain has become so widespread in wartime Russia that people have begun to label the women who do so "black widows."

Courts tackling the problem are trying to determine whether the marriages were genuine or entered into by the woman purely for financial gain upon their husband's death.

Russian lawmakers have

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Just launched: AI Agent Studio

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